

Olivia Axiuk

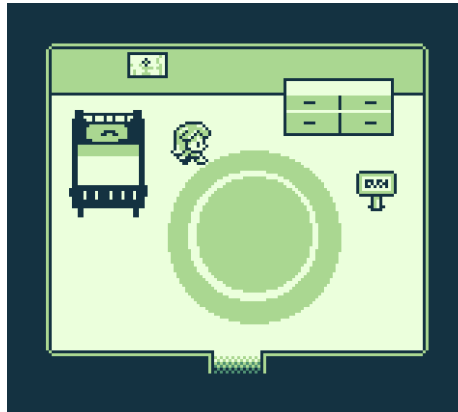
CART 315

Professor Matthew Bethancourt

Due 2026-01-21

Game Prototyping Journal 01

For this week, our task was simply to “make a thing” using the provided beginner-friendly game engine tools to make a limited-scope project. Due to my current interest in retro consoles, the possibility of making a GameBoy compatible game with GameBoy Studio was very appealing. As well, the promise of a beginner-friendly “drag and drop” style engine piqued my interest. Although I have created small game-like applications in the past using mainly JavaScript, I liked that GameBoy Studio provided the opportunity for quick experimentation while providing ready-made and easily editable assets to jumpstart the process.



An example of a room, which was initially empty, edited by me to have furniture in Photoshop.

To begin creating this project, I explored the template game given by GameBoy studio, studying the way that the player interacted with objects and characters, opening the code and getting to know the program. I decided that my idea would be a quaint game where the player explores a small town, helping with everyday tasks given by the NPCs. Having some prior coding knowledge, I found the interface of GameBoy studio especially easy to use, simplifying coding terms and often-used functions into simple drop-down menus. At the beginning of the process, I found the experience overall pleasant, easy to use and encouraging for someone relatively new to gamemaking.



Gameplay Interaction with an NPC.

However, one glaring issue severely slowed down my process and, unfortunately, negatively affected my enjoyment of the GameBoy Studio process. A strange issue arose that affected the program's ability to compile the game. It became very frustrating when I would make changes to my game, but find myself unable to see them applied. The problem seems to be a common one with GameBoy studio, which does, as of now, not have a solution. I had to find workarounds for the glitch, but every solution would only work for a short amount of time before my game would stop compiling again. As a result, many hours I would have spent working on the actual gameplay were instead allocated to fixing this problem, and the scope of my game was greatly minimized.



As well, I got a save and load function to work.

Of course, not all was in vain. I found that bringing in the provided assets into Photoshop, where I edited them to suit my game better, provided an opportunity to study and modify game-ready pixel art. As well, the experience was also a lesson in planning and anticipating for glitches and setbacks, something inevitable during the game making process. Overall, the “Make

a Thing” project still introduced me to a new way of making games, and the program was fun enough to use that I would be willing to give it a second chance.